as the CDS and Secretary DMA, we thought this would be an easy process, especially since the restructuring was Gen Rawat's idea. However, that was not to be. Since the restructuring involved the creation and re-designation of appointments at the JS (Maj Gen) and above level, it had to go for clearance to the Ministry of Finance as per policy in vogue.[23] The new structure was not only financially neutral but even financially beneficial, yet it had to be supported by copious amounts of paperwork. There were some hiccups, as there are bound to be in the implementation of any new policy or process. Some of the DGs were unhappy with having to work under officers junior to them in service; others for losing the PSO tag. The DGMT position was optimized to make way for the new appointment of the DCOAS (Strat). Although we tried our best, through the latter half of 2019 and early 2020, to push the case through, when the crisis began in Eastern Ladakh in May 2020, almost three years after the Doklam crisis of 2017, we were still operating under the old system. It would not do wait indefinitely for the process to take its own sweet time. I pointed out to the RM that an operationally required and financially neutral proposal was being stymied by bureaucratic hurdles and that we could wait no longer. In this, I had the full support and backing of the CDS. Accordingly, in September 2020, I ordered a 'soft launch' of the new establishment. Designations and offices would remain the same, but all Dtes and Branches would start working as per the new charter and organization and route their files accordingly. This was to prove to be of great benefit, particularly when Emergency Power was delegated to the Service HQ, because now the DCOAS (CD&S) could prioritize and balance out both the capital acquisition and sustenance requirement. Lt Gen Paramjit Singh Sangha, the

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